OBLIVION

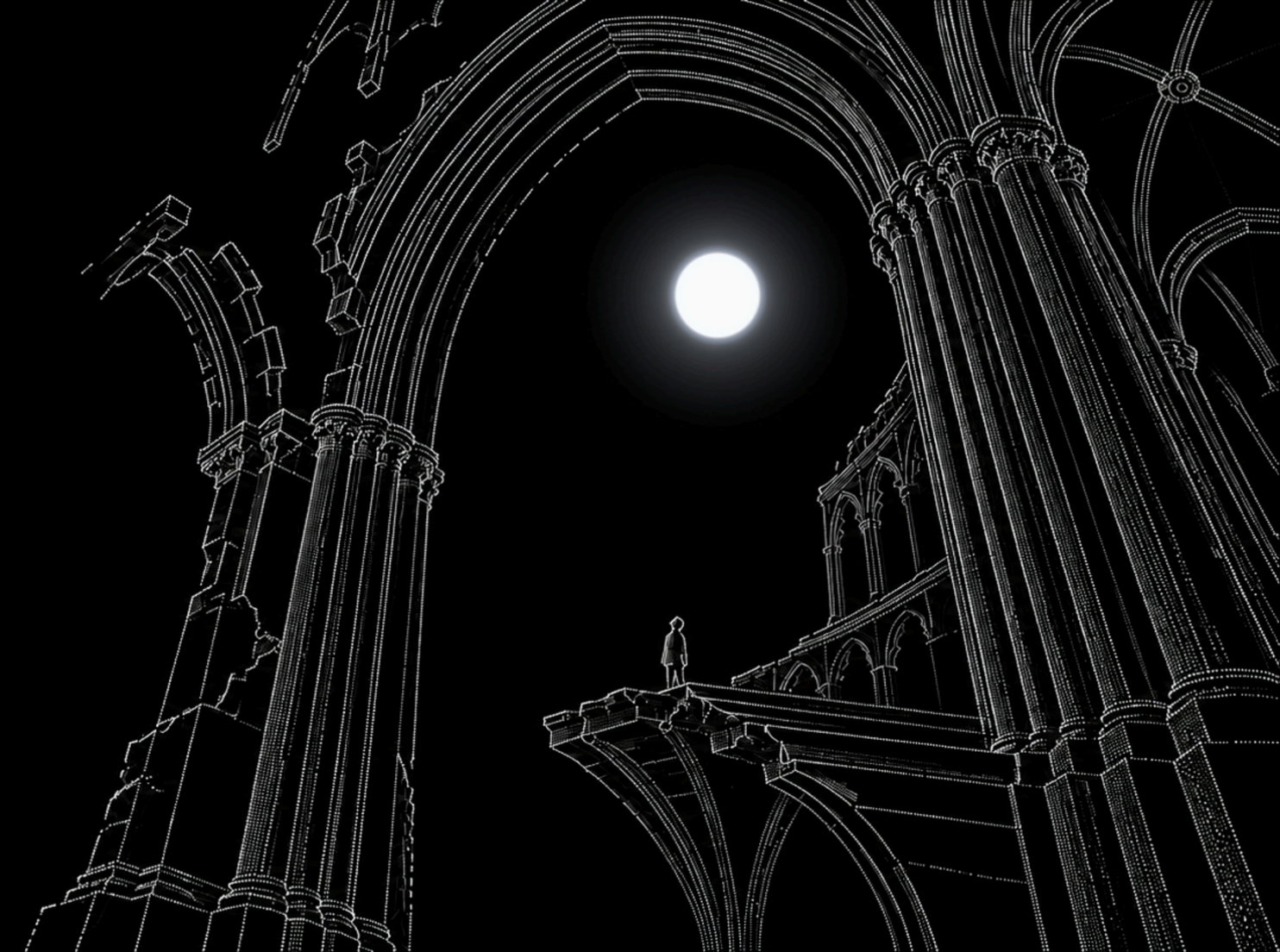
A brief encounter can be enough.

A first-person exploration of attention and impermanence.
Gaze gives a fading world temporary form.

Gold Medal
BYAA
China Regional

45K
VIDEO VIEWS
Bilibili

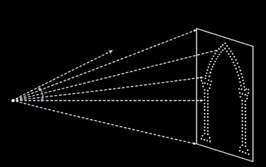
Solo design & development / Concept cover

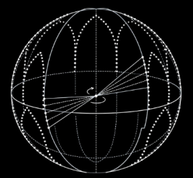


Engineering a fragile world.

I moved from projecting particles onto a surface to selecting the contours of three-dimensional architecture. Each step was judged by how convincingly a player could turn, read and navigate the world.

EARLY PROJECTION TESTS





A / Planar projection

I first rendered all particles on a single plane. I could move freely, but the result felt flat. Turning the view exposed the projection's limitations and introduced visual problems.

B / Spherical projection

While playing Return of the Obra Dinn, I was inspired to surround the viewpoint with a sphere. Surface points no longer needed rearranging just to rotate the view. The approach was lighter to render, but space still felt less convincing.

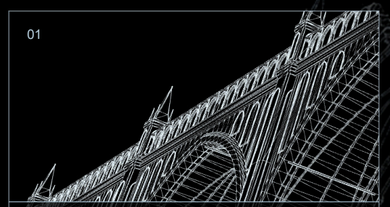
From prototype to runtime

Mesh attributes store particle positions, phases and timing; the vertex shader handles formation and drift. A shared budget prioritises contour coverage, while distance culling disables out-of-range renderers after fading. Permanently fixed objects use a compact data variant.

Projection diagrams: AI-generated conceptual reconstructions.

Supplied bridge concept · Windows: Unity captures · Inset: recorded gameplay, exposure lifted.

01



01 / DENSE MESH EDGES

Reading the full mesh

Raw triangle edges expose subdivisions as well as architecture. I compare them with selected boundaries before turning useful contours into particles.

02



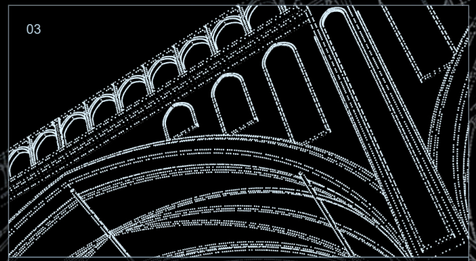
02 / STRUCTURAL EDGE STUDY

Selecting useful edges

Selected structural edges provide a reference for reducing visual noise. In the runtime, I weld nearby vertices and compare adjacent face normals to retain boundaries and pronounced turns.

The edge plan is cached per object and reused when its particle budget changes.

03



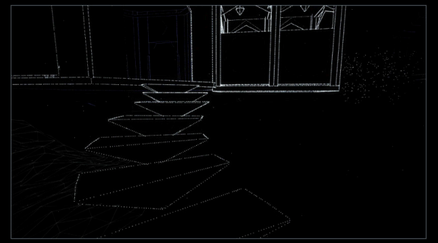
03 / PARTICLES + LINE SCENERY

A hybrid, playable world

The final world combines animated particles with stable background lines. Selected scenery uses wireframe and leaves the particle scan, avoiding duplicate scanning for those meshes.

I allocate rendering detail by role: changing, interactive forms receive particles; background geometry keeps the wider space readable.

GAMEPLAY / 03:05



Wireframe terrain + particle platforms.

The world fades.
We still choose to know it.

Even if the world vanishes and memory fades, is an encounter still worthwhile?
In OBLIVION, play grows from a memory world:
come to know it, return to it, and finally rebuild it through your own steps.

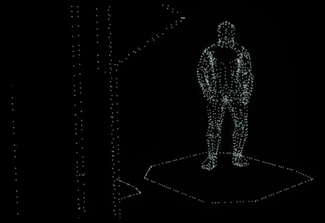
Meaning lies in the encounter itself.



01 / ONE PREMISE: A WORLD OF MEMORY

To gaze is to remember.

Only what is remembered takes form.



Seeing yourself in a mirror / 04:08

Gaze gathers objects. Seeing your reflection gathers your body. Gazing at a reflected object creates its mirrored counterpart. All three follow one premise: seeing, remembering and taking form.

Look away, and mutable forms disperse. An eclipse erases those still dispersed. Remembering can hold a form for a while, changing the present without preserving it forever.

ATMOSPHERE / ANNAKATA MOUNTAIN

Its mystery made me want to explore. I use particle architecture, piano, moonlight and darkness to invite lingering. Like scenery and music aboard a sinking ship, these encounters remain worth experiencing.

Above: concept artwork / Below: gameplay captures

02 / THOUGHT AND EXPLORATION IN DIALOGUE

A thought becomes the next journey.

Outer Wilds taught me to align thought with exploration: knowledge prompts a hypothesis; exploration answers it with a discovery that sparks another thought. I want the same map to keep offering new possibilities as understanding grows.
Players gain no new ability; what they learn changes where they can go.
Knowledge grows through thought, rather than acting as a key to collect.

Knowledge → hypothesis → exploration → discovery



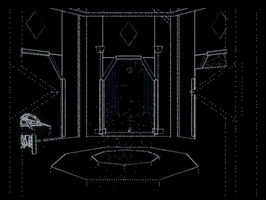
Learning a route through movement / 05:20

Outer Wilds / Mobius Digital



Timber Hearth at night / Trailer

OBLIVION / Gameplay



Revisiting a familiar space

03 / FROM THE MAP TO PERSONAL MEMORY

A world remembered through movement.

Through repeated play, I learned to find familiar footholds even in darkness. Simple platforming turns position, distance and rhythm into bodily familiarity: the map gradually moves from screen to mind.
In the finale, players retrace the vanished map from memory. Each step restores the object beneath it. Their movements rebuild a memory world shaped by personal experience.

One map. Three understandings.

The same places return with new uses. Once their rules are understood, a single attempt is enough.

CRESCENT

I / FIRST EXPLORATION

Learn by moving.

1 / Gaze makes a path
The stair gathers under observation. Climbing establishes a landmark the player will revisit.

2-3 / Notice before knowing
Distinctive mirror frames are encountered before their purpose is understood.

4-5 / Return with a new body
A straight corridor frames the player's reflection. The gathered self crosses dispersed matter, returning to familiar mirrors to apply the rule.

6 / Make loss visible
The cathedral directs attention toward the moon. During the eclipse, dispersed things, including the player, are erased.

ECLIPSE / CYCLE ENDS

At the eclipse, dispersed things are erased.

One stair, three uses: 1 / 8 / 12.

II / SECOND EXPLORATION

Recognise the shortcut.

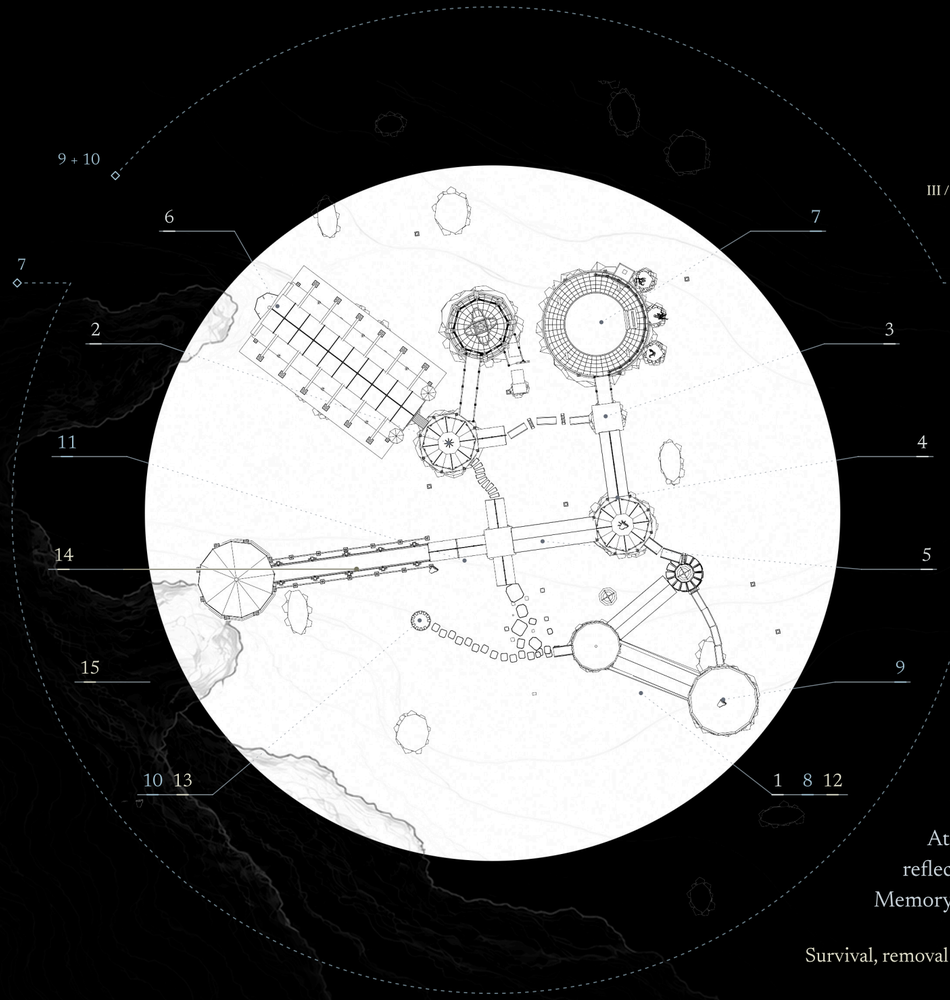
7 / Reflection becomes structure
Gathering a reflection forms its counterpart in the world.

8 / Absence reveals a passage
Erasing the stair exposes the passage it concealed.

4-5 → **9 / Begin at the ceiling mirror**
The ceiling mirror gathers the player at the start.

10-11 / Arrive too late
At the viewpoint, the gate is gone but the bridge is already lost. An open entrance alone cannot create a crossing.

9 gives HOW; 10 gives WHY. Together they suggest 12.



III / THIRD EXPLORATION

Act before erasure.

12 / Use the starting mirror
Gather yourself at the ceiling mirror and cross the still-dispersed stair before erasure.

13 / Coordinate the eclipse
One eclipse, three coordinated outcomes:
Player gathered → survives
Bridge gathered → retained
Gate dispersed → erased

14 / Extend the crossing
Facing mirrors reuse the rule from 7: reflected sections gather into a walkable bridge toward the mountain.

15 / Rebuild through memory
At the lake, the player watches their reflection as the world vanishes. Memory begins reconstruction.

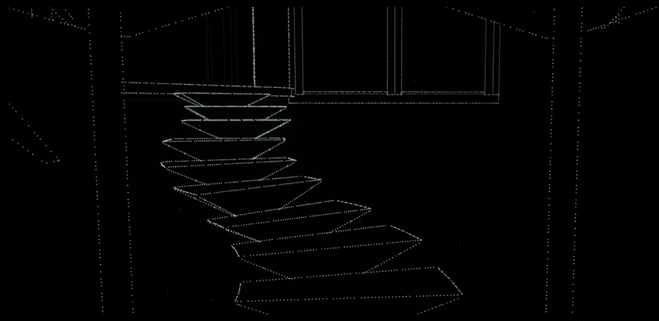
Survival, removal and extension become one plan.

Knowing changes the way.

The same stair offers a climb, an opening below and an early shortcut. Each route follows from what the player knows.

01 / THE OPENING STAIR

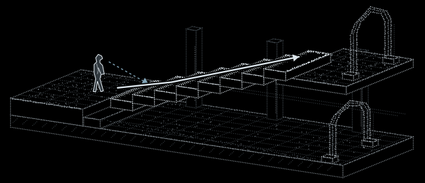
One stair, understood three times.



Opening stair / recorded gameplay, 03:04 ····· GAZE —— MOVEMENT

THREE STATES / SAME SCHEMATIC VIEW

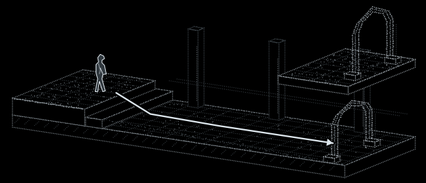
1 / Gather and climb



STAIR GATHERED

Gaze gathers the stair into a walkable route to the upper level.

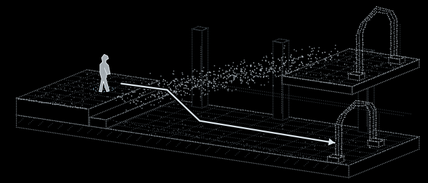
2 / Enter the opening



STAIR ERASED

The first eclipse erases the stair and exposes the passage underneath.

3 / Cross before erasure



SELF GATHERED / STAIR DISPERSED

On a new attempt, gather yourself in the ceiling mirror and cross the dispersed stair before the eclipse.

CLUES FROM THE FIRST ATTEMPT



VIEWPOINT / WHY ARRIVE EARLY?

The bridge is already gone. Arriving before the eclipse lets the player preserve it.



BELOW ABOVE

CEILING MIRROR / HOW TO ARRIVE EARLY?

Below, the frameless reflection reads as a distant room. Above, the chandelier top and reflected self reveal a mirror you can stand on.

BOTH CLUES INFORM THE NEXT ATTEMPT

Gather yourself at the start and reach the viewpoint before the eclipse.

02 / APPLY THE RULES

A / Gather, then look away



SELF DISPERSED



SELF GATHERED

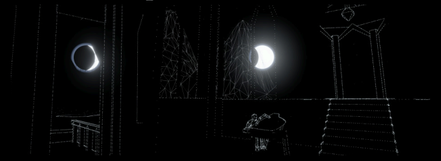


THE DOORWAY

Gather yourself in the mirror, then fall through the dispersed floor.

Look away. Back through the dispersed door.

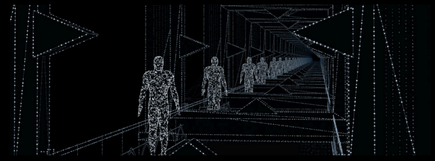
B / One eclipse, three outcomes



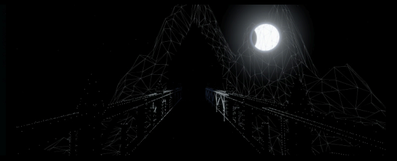
MOON PHASES AT THE PIANO COURT / GAMEPLAY

SELF	BRIDGE	GATE
Gathered	Gathered	Dispersed
Survives	**Preserved**	**Erased**

C / Extend the road



RECURSIVE REFLECTION / 3D RENDER

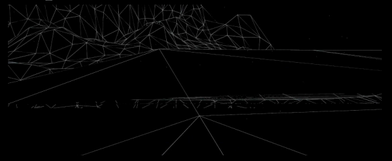


CROSSING / GAMEPLAY

Facing mirrors repeat the bridge and your reflection. Hold your gaze on a reflected bridge section to give it a walkable counterpart.

03 / ENDING

Step, then see



FINAL TERRAIN / GAMEPLAY

Gaze leaves the route dark. Step to reveal nearby forms. A misstep returns you to the last foothold.

GAMEPLAY VIEWS SHOW INDIVIDUAL STATES AND LOCATIONS / BRIDGE RECURSION IS A 3D DESIGN DEMONSTRATION

Learning in public.

Listening changed the way this world feels.

01 / ATMOSPHERE

要努力变强的咸鱼…
27 Jul 2026 · 15:55

“The dark environment looks difficult to read. Could the outlines be clearer?”

116 Reply

adios12312 AUTHOR 28 Jul 2026 · 03:17

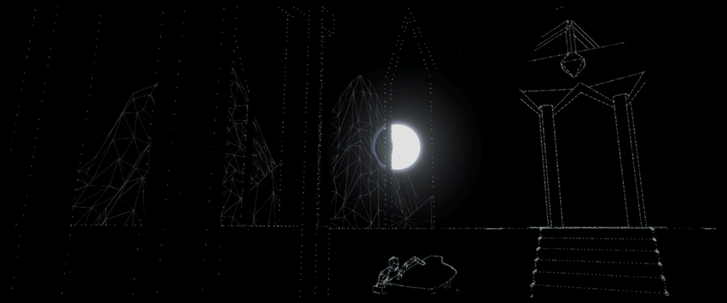
“Helping players see clearly is important.” 1

DESIGN JUDGMENT

Let the darkness open into distance.

The near-only view felt enclosed, even in open areas. I wanted stillness rather than fear of the unseen.

MONO NO AWARE



Gameplay capture · Moon halo and line-rendered peaks

MY DEVELOPMENT RESPONSE

Distance, without clutter.
Distance-dimmed particles extend the view and soften its transition into darkness.

Moonlight that feels present.
A textured moon and halo suggest illumination, opening the compressed dark.

A horizon beyond the particles.
A separate line-rendered mountain brings space and quiet: closer to mono no aware.

02–03 / MOVEMENT & LEGIBILITY

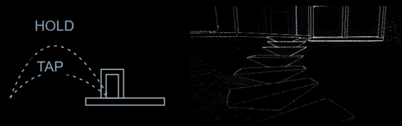
Citric__Acid_
30 Jul 2026 · 01:32 / WEB PLAYTEST

“I kept falling and restarting before the later areas.” “So many points can be visually tiring.”

4 Reply Two excerpts from the same comment

MY DEVELOPMENT RESPONSE

02 / Make landing forgiving.



SCHEMATIC Gameplay / 03:05

Hold Space to control jump height. More continuous jumps, wider platforms and a larger player collider keep attention on the atmosphere.

03 / Let words keep their form.



Gameplay / outlined text / 05:30

Particle-only words competed with architecture. Outlines appear after gathering: clearer text with less particle pressure, at the cost of some visual delicacy.

04 / GAZE & DISCOVERY

Cynical_
27 Jul 2026 · 11:07 / VIDEO RESPONSE

“It looks hard to get started.”

11 Reply

adios12312 · AUTHOR · 28 JUL 2026

“The guidance is still lacking.” 6

MY DEVELOPMENT RESPONSE

Long gathering waits could hide the correct route. I shortened gaze-to-form time to make progress and triggers easier to discover.

EARLIER
REVISED FORM